

In fact, a former Facebook executive, Chamath Paliapitiya has expressed his regret for being involved in building the social media platform that he thinks is negatively affecting society: "I think we have created tools that are ripping apart the social fabric of how society works," he told an audience at the Stanford Graduate School of Business. He joined Facebook in 2007 and became its vice president of user growth.

"The short-term, dopamine-driven feedback loops we've created are destroying how society works," Paliapitiya claimed. He cites issues of misinformation and mistruth that have resulted through social media. For instance, Paliapitiya discussed an incident in India where a hoax message about kidnappings shared via WhatsApp led to the lynching of seven innocent people.

"That's what we're dealing with. And imagine taking that to the extreme, where bad actors can now manipulate large swathes of people to do anything you want," Paliapitiya explained. And, with the rising issue this year of fake news and even manipulated videos, it's only more difficult to monitor and catch misinformation on social media.

Temperature-regulating coffee mug

Beautifully designed to be used in your home or at your desk, the Ember ceramic mug keeps your beverages at the perfect temperature from the first sip to the last drop for as long as you want. For that, you need to choose the exact temperature in Ember's companion app, or pick from a preset.

Spending \$80 on a mug could look ridiculous but it's also wonderful, for every beverage has an ideal temperature for consumption. For coffee, science says it's 136 degrees. (Ember defaults to 135, which is pretty close to it.) Ember keeps your coffee exactly right for hours.



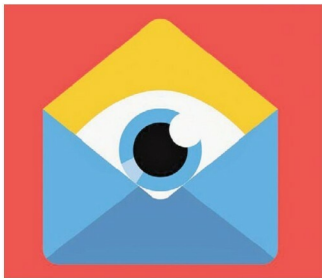
Ember ceramic mug keeps your coffee exactly right for hours

Heating and cooling things is easy, but doing so uniformly poses a challenge. Ember CEO Clay Alexander found the solution was to create a convection current, like a radiator or a pot of water. So Ember uses cooling and heating elements up the sides of the mug—it activates the highest submerged element, and cools that spot until the cold liquid begins to fall. That displaces hotter liquid, moving it up to the top, where another element on the other side does the same thing. Alexander says even in his early prototypes, he was able to keep the temperature within one degree from top to bottom. With the help of design firm Ammunition, Alexander turned his ideas into a beautiful mug.

E-mail tracking is in vogue

According to OMC, 19 per cent of all conversational emails are now tracked. That's one in five of the e-mails you get from your friends. And you probably never noticed.

E-mail tracking service Streak notifies the sender as soon as his message is opened. It can tell him where, when and on what kind of device it was read. So with Streak enabled, you can easily be caught fooling around with messages like "I read your mail just now."



E-mail tracking service Streak notifies the sender as soon as his message is opened (Image credit: Getty Images)

The technology is pretty simple. Tracking clients embed a line of code in the body of an e-mail—usually in a 1x1 pixel image (which is so tiny that it's invisible), but also in elements like hyperlinks and custom fonts. When a recipient opens the e-mail, the tracking client recognises that the pixel has been downloaded, as well as where and on what device. Newsletter services, marketers and advertisers have used the technique for years, to collect data about their open rates; major tech companies like Facebook and Twitter followed suit in their ongoing quest to profile and predict users' behaviour online.

But lately, a surprising—and growing—number of tracked emails are being sent not from corporations, but acquaintances.